

Henry And Katherine: The Tudor Heart [B2]

Questo gioiello, che reca le iniziali di Enrico VIII e Caterina d'Aragona, ci parla del lusso che caratterizzava la corte del re.



In 2019, a metal detectorist [unearthed](#) an exceptional [find](#) in a field in Warwickshire, central England: a [dazzling, heart-shaped pendant](#) made of [24-carat](#) gold, dating back to the 16th century. Inscribed with the [intertwined](#) initials 'H' and 'K', the artifact was made to celebrate Henry VIII's marriage to Katherine of Aragon. According to specialists, it is a very rare piece of history.

THE TUDOR BACKGROUND

Henry VIII, who was king of England from 1509 to 1547, is well-known for having six wives in an obsessive [quest](#) to have a male [heir](#), and Katherine of Aragon was his first con[quest](#). Katherine was a Spanish princess who was previously married to Arthur, Henry's older brother and [heir](#) apparent to the throne. When Arthur died suddenly in 1502, Katherine [became engaged](#) to Henry and they married when Henry became king in 1509. Katherine was devoted to her husband, and even acted as regent while Henry was away, playing a significant role in the defence of England against an attempted invasion. However, Henry's [quest](#) for a male [heir](#) was never fulfilled in his union with Katherine, as only one daughter out of [their](#) six children survived. Henry started courting Katherine's [lady-in-waiting](#), Anne Boleyn, and asked the Pope to annul his marriage to Katherine in 1527. When the Pope refused, Henry decided to break away from the Catholic Church and to found the Church of England. Culture

The Koh-i-Noor: The World's Most Dangerous Diamond Il Koh-i-Noor è il diamante più ambito e maledetto al mondo. Per secoli vari imperi hanno lottato per cercare di impossessarsi di [quest](#)a straordinaria gemma. Il suo incorporamento ai gioielli della corona britannica è avvolto in una sanguinosa leggenda. Conor Gleeson , Sarah Davison

A ROYAL RELIC

The Tudor Heart is an important historical witness to Henry and Katherine's relationship, as most objects linked to it have been lost over time. The Heart acts like a window into the luxury of Henry VIII's earlier [reign](#) and the strong union between Henry and Katherine. Researchers believe the pendant may have been created for a tournament that was held in October 1518, to mark [their](#) daughter's engagement to the French [heir](#) apparent. Henry was known to [commission](#) London [goldsmiths](#) to create [custom-made](#) jewellery for members of the court to wear at major celebrations and state events.

A MUSEUM APPEAL

The Heart was found and then reported under the Treasure [Act](#) of 1996. This law says that anyone who discovers a possible treasure must report it to the

authorities. People who do this can also receive a [reward](#) for helping to protect and share history. The British Museum now has the chance to buy the Heart so that it can stay in public hands and not be sold to a private collector. To do this, the museum needs to [raise](#) £3.5 million by April 2026. It has asked the public to help by making donations. The campaign is supported by British actor Damian Lewis, who played King Henry VIII in the TV series Wolf Hall. If the museum successfully [raises](#) the funds, the money will typically be [split](#) equally between the [finder](#) and the [landowner](#), as this is the normal protocol in such cases.

Glossary

- **raise** = raccogliere fondi
- **goldsmiths** = orefici
- **split** = dividere
- **heart-shaped pendant** = ciondolo a forma di cuore
- **intertwined** = intrecciate
- **heir** = erede
- **lady-in-waiting** = dama di compagnia
- **custom-made** = su misura, personalizzati
- **Act** = legge
- **reward** = ricompensa
- **unearthed** = dissotterrare
- **dazzling** = scintillante
- **quest** = ricerca
- **heir apparent** = erede legittimo
- **became engaged** = fidanzarsi (con promessa di matrimonio)
- **reign** = regno
- **landowner** = proprietario terriero
- **find** = ritrovamento, scoperta
- **24-carat** = di 24 carati
- **commission** = commissionare